

Chiasmodon niger

Black swallow



Length Up to 10 in (25 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Tropical and subtropical waters worldwide



The black swallow belongs to a small group of marine deep-water fishes that are



able to catch and eat fishes larger than themselves. They can do this because their mouths and stomachs can be greatly extended to accommodate prey. Once the contents of the stomach are digested, the fishes regain their normal shape. The black swallow lives in the deep ocean but may move to slightly shallower waters to feed. It has 2 dorsal fins, a long anal fin with a single spine, and a forked tail.

Echiichthys vipera

Lesser weeverfish



Length Up to 6 in (15 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

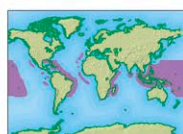
Location E. North Atlantic, Mediterranean



This venomous fish, frequently found near European beaches, is known to inflict painful wounds if stepped upon. Spines on the first dorsal fin and gill cover have poison glands at their bases; if disturbed, this fish erects these as a warning, or uses them in defense against larger fishes. This species spends much of its time buried in the seabed with only its eyes and the dorsal fin tip exposed.

Heteropriacanthus cruentatus

Glasseye



Length Up to 20 in (50 cm)
Weight Up to 5½ lb (2.5 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Tropical waters worldwide



This solitary fish gets its name from the brilliant reflective layer—called the tapetum lucidum—in its large, conspicuous eyes. It spends the day under, or near, ridges of rock formations or reefs, emerging only at night to feed on a variety of prey, including small fishes, shrimps, octopus, crabs, and marine worms. Young glasseyes, unlike the adults, spend their time in the open sea.

Cromileptes altivelis

Humpback grouper



Length Up to 28 in (70 cm)
Weight Up to 7¼ lb (3.5 kg)
Sex Sequential hermaphrodite
Status Vulnerable

Location Indo-Pacific



This small humpback grouper, also known as the Barramundi cod or pantherfish, has very distinctive coloration, with a whitish head, body, and fins all covered with small, widely spaced black spots. Its back rises steeply behind its head in a "hump." Groupers typically change from female to male as they get older. Apart from the fact that it lays eggs, little is known about the breeding biology of this species.

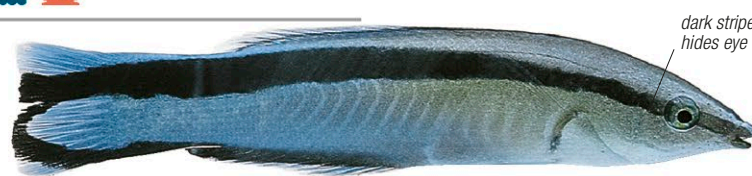
Labroides dimidiatus

Cleaner wrasse



Length Up to 4½ in (11.5 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Sequential hermaphrodite
Status Least concern

Location Indo-Pacific



The cleaner wrasse, an important member of coral- reef communities, feeds on parasites infesting other fishes, as well as on their mucus and scales. "Client" fishes queue up at special cleaning stations, which are usually occupied by a pair of wrasses or a group of females with an adult male. Once the dominant male dies, he is replaced not by another male, but by the dominant female, which changes sex.

Perca fluviatilis

European perch



Length Up to 20 in (51 cm)
Weight Up to 10 lb (4.5 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern



The European perch is a freshwater fish that inhabits slow- moving rivers, deep lakes, and ponds. Juveniles feed on small planktonic creatures and invertebrates; adults eat invertebrates and small fishes, such as sticklebacks, minnows, and even other European perch. Smaller fishes tend to group together, while larger individuals are more solitary, preferring to lie close to a large rock or among aquatic vegetation. Important both commercially

EGG STRINGS



Female European perch lay their eggs in lacelike strings, wrapping them around riverbed stones or underwater plants. A single clutch can contain up to 300,000 eggs, connected by their sticky mucus. The eggs hatch in about 2-3 weeks.

and as a sport fish, it has been introduced to non-European countries such as Australia. In some places, this has caused significant ecological damage.

STRIPED

A deep-bodied fish, the European perch has 2 dorsal fins and characteristic dark, vertical stripes, usually 6 in number.

*Lepomis cyanellus*

Green sunfish



Length Up to 12 in (31 cm)
Weight 35 oz (975 g)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location E. USA



At home in a wide variety of habitats, from sluggish streams to lakes and ponds, the green sunfish is one of the most common large freshwater fish in North America. It forms relatively

large breeding colonies, and is found in groups around aquatic vegetation and shelter. During the breeding season, between late spring and early summer, the male uses his tail to scrape out a shallow nest in which the female lays her eggs. The eggs stick to the gravel bed and the males guard them and the newly hatched young for a few days.

